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To the Hiring Committee.

I am pleased to write this letter of recommendation for Zackery Duhala as he completes his teaching credential in biology. I am Zackery's master teacher at Castle Park High school and have had the pleasure of working closely with Zackery during his student teacher experience, and I can say he is a dedicated, reflective, and highly capable educator who is prepared to make a meaningful impact in the classroom.

Zackery brings a genuine passion for science that is evident in both his teaching and his interactions with students. This passion stemmed from his early experience with impactful teachers and hands-on science experiences. This foundation clearly translates into his teaching practice, where he consistently strives to make biology relevant, engaging and accessible to all learners. His lessons are thoughtfully designed, well sequenced and incorporate a variety of strategies that promote inquiry, critical thinking, and real world connections.

One of Zackery's greatest strengths is his ability to build meaningful relationships with students. He creates a classroom environment where students feel supported, respected, and motivated to participate. His background working with diverse youth populations has helped him develop strong interpersonal skills and a deep understanding of meeting students where they are. Students respond positively to his approachable demeanor and genuine investment in their success.

In addition to his strong rapport with students, Zackery demonstrates a consistent commitment to growth and reflection. He actively seeks feedback and uses it to refine his instructional practices, showing a level of professionalism and self awareness that is essential for long term success in education. His perseverance, work ethic and collaborative mindset-qualities shaped in part by his experience in athletics and mentorship- are evidence in all aspects of his teaching.

Zackery is not only a capable educator but also a mentor who is committed to supporting students both academically and personally. He embodies the qualities of an educator who will inspire curiosity, foster confidence, and encourage students to take pride in their learning.

I highly recommend Zackery Duhala with a teaching position without reservation. He will be a valuable asset to any school community.

Sincerely,

Jennifer Jones
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